

London Vintage Markets & Hidden Gems

10 Markets · Sat & Sun · All London

London's vintage scene hides extraordinary finds — Victorian jewellery for £5, designer labels for pennies, antiques that would cost 10x in a shop. This guide tells you exactly where to go, when to arrive, and what to look for.

YOU SAVE: £187 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide
£12.99

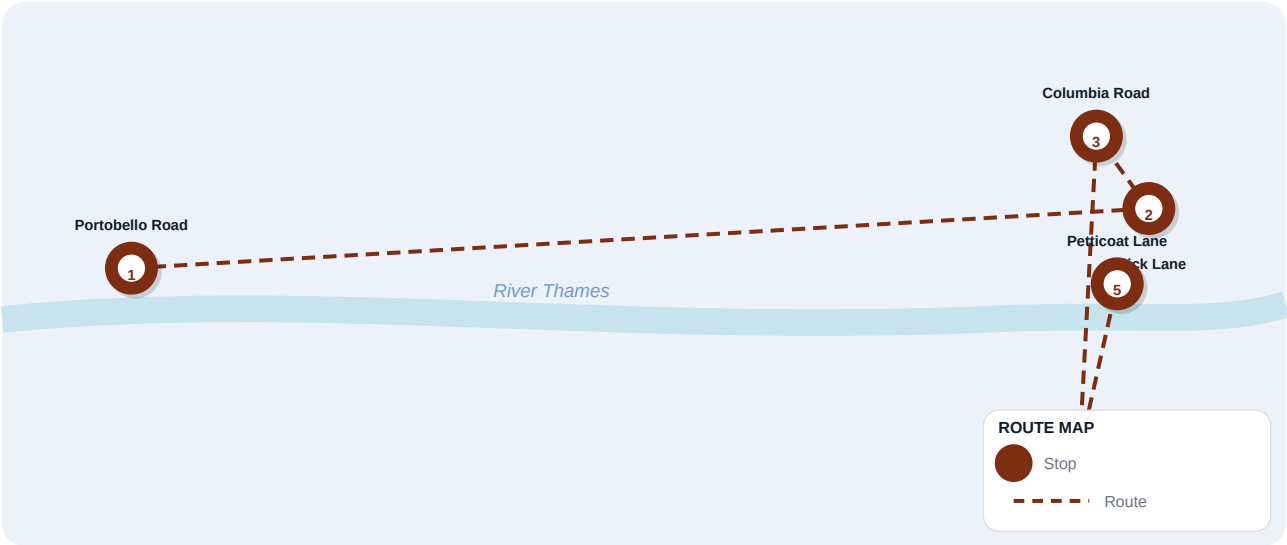
Equivalent guided tours
£200

YOUR SAVING
£187

ROUTE INFO

■ Start	Portobello Road Market (Notting Hill)
■ End	Petticoat Lane Market (Spitalfields/Aldgate)
■ Duration	Sat & Sun
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location
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■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — LONDON VINTAGE MARKETS & HIDDEN GEMS

Follow stops 1→5 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

Portobello Road Market

Notting Hill · Sat 8am–5pm (antiques) · Mon–Fri partial market

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

The world's largest antiques market — 1,000 stalls on Saturdays. The secret: arrive at 7am before dealers, walk from Notting Hill Gate south toward Ladbroke Grove. The early stalls are trade — dealers buying from dealers — and you can often buy at the same price.

■ SAVING

Dealers mark up 200–400% by 10am. Arriving at 7am saves: £20–100 per find

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Notting Hill Gate (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 2

DO THIS:

- ✓ Arrive 7am — dealers buy before tourists wake up
- ✓ The section under the Westway arches: fashion & vinyl
- ✓ The antiques are Golborne Road end — cheapest stalls

■ Best: Saturday 7–9am for trade prices

AVOID:

Saturday noon — impossibly crowded

★★★★★

Free entry

2

Brick Lane Vintage Market

Shoreditch · Sunday 10am–5pm

■ 30 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

Sunday only. The Truman Brewery complex houses Vintage Market (10am–5pm) with 150+ vendors. The secret floor: upstairs in the Old Truman Brewery main building has the best and cheapest stalls — most visitors stay ground floor.

■ SAVING

Vintage shops nearby charge 3x the market price. Saving per item: £15–40

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Shoreditch High Street (Overground) or
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Upstairs Truman Brewery — cheaper, better stock
- ✓ Bagel shops on Brick Lane: 80p bagels, legendary
- ✓ The street art changes weekly — photograph the doorways

■ Best: Sunday 10–11am before it gets busy

AVOID:

Arriving after noon on Sunday — manic

★★★★★

Free entry

3



Columbia Road Flower Market

Bethnal Green · Sunday only 8am–3pm

■ 12 min from Brick Lane

HIDDEN TIP

Sunday 8am–3pm only. 50+ flower stalls selling direct from growers — prices at close (1:30pm) drop to 10–20% of shop prices. The surrounding streets have the best independent vintage and art shops in East London. The cockney flower-seller patter is performance art.

■ SAVING

Florists charge £30 for a bouquet that costs £5–8 here. Saving: £20+

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Hoxton Overground (10 min walk)
Cost: Zone 2

DO THIS:

- ✓ Arrive at 1:30pm — flowers sell for £1 a bunch
- ✓ The surrounding shops on Columbia Road (free browse)
- ✓ Café 281 — the best coffee on the street
- Best: 8–9am for best stock · 1:30pm for dramatic price drops

AVOID:

Arriving with a car — streets close

★★★★★

Free entry

4



Bermondsey Antiques Market

Bermondsey · Friday only, 6am–2pm

■ 30 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

The professionals' market — dealers, restorers, and serious collectors only before 9am. By law, sellers of stolen goods could claim ignorance if sold before sunrise (an old piece of law now repealed but the 4am tradition continues). Start time is now 6am.

■ SAVING

Items available here for £20 sell in antique shops for £100+. Saving: massive

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Bermondsey (5 min walk) or London
Cost: Zone 2

DO THIS:

- ✓ Friday only — starts at 6am (bring a torch in winter)
- ✓ Silver, jewellery, clocks — extraordinary quality
- ✓ The café across the road opens at 6am for traders
- Best: Friday 6–8am for dealer prices

AVOID:

Arriving after 10am — best stock gone

★★★★★

Free entry



Petticoat Lane Market

■ 25 min from Bermondsey

Spitalfields/Aldgate · Sunday 9am–2pm (Wentworth Street also Mon–Fri)

HIDDEN TIP

London's oldest street market (officially since 1936 but trading since the 17th century). Sunday only for the full market. The surrounding Spitalfields area has Georgian Huguenot houses now occupied by Bangladeshi families — a direct line of immigrant history over 300 years.

■ SAVING

Street markets are the original cheap shopping. Average saving vs shops: 40–60%

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Aldgate East (3 min walk) or Liverpool
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Wander Fournier Street for the architectural history
 - ✓ The Bangladeshi sweet shops on Brick Lane (1 min away)
 - ✓ Bargain hard — expected by all traders
- Best: Sunday morning 9–11am

AVOID:

Arriving expecting a vintage market — it's budget clothing and househo...



Free entry

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	Portobello Road Market	Notting Hill	Start here	Free entry	Notting Hill Gate	★★★★★
2	Brick Lane Vintage Mar...	Shoreditch	30 min or tube	Free entry	Shoreditch High St	★★★★★
3	Columbia Road Flower M...	Bethnal Green	12 min from Br	Free entry	Hoxton Overground	★★★★★
4	Bermondsey Antiques Ma...	Bermondsey	30 min or tube	Free entry	Bermondsey (5 min	★★★★★
5	Petticoat Lane Market	Spitalfields/Ald	25 min from Be	Free entry	Aldgate East (3 mi	★★★███

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